

Word family: **card / cards / carded / carding / cardboard / cardholder**

Base word: card

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also **verb**

Related forms:

* **card** (n.) — 卡；咭；紙牌；卡片；證件；名片；成績卡

* **card** (v.) — 要求出示年齡證明；以卡處理 / 記錄；梳理纖維

* **cardholder** (n.) — 持卡人；卡套

* **cardboard** (n./adj.) — 紙板；硬紙板的

* **carding** (n.) — 梳理纖維；刷卡欺詐 *(specialist)*

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **gift card**

* **birthday card**

* **greeting card**

* **bank card**

* **credit card**

* **debit card**

* **ID card**

* **membership card**

* **business card**

* **playing card**

* **a pack/deck of cards**

* **report card**

* **scorecard**

* **red card / yellow card**

* **wild card**

* **trump card**

* **calling card**

* **on the cards**

* **play your cards right**

* **show your cards**

* **keep your cards close to your chest**

* **card someone**

* **cardholder**

Meaning in this passage

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, chocolates, wallets, or gift
cards.

Here, **gift cards** means:

prepaid cards or digital vouchers containing a set amount of money that can be spent at a particular shop or service — 禮品卡；禮券卡

中文翻譯：

以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、朱古力、銀包，或者**禮品卡**。

So here:

gift card = 預先儲有一定金額、讓收禮者自行購買商品或服務的卡

1. **card (卡片；咭)** — 卡；卡片

This is the broad physical sense underlying many compounds.

Practice 1

> She handed me a small **card**.

她遞給我一張小**卡片**。

Practice 2

> Write your name on the **card**.

把你的名字寫在**卡片**上。

Practice 3

> There was a note attached to the **card**.

那張**卡片**上附有一張紙條。

MCQ-ready definition:

card = 一張通常較厚、較硬的紙或塑膠片，可用來書寫、識別、付款或表示某種用途

2. **gift card** — 禮品卡

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original context

> I sometimes gave people **gift cards**.

我有時會送別人**禮品卡**。

Practice 2

> She used the **gift card** to buy a book.

她用**禮品卡**買了一本書。

Practice 3

> The **gift card** has a value of \$50.

這張**禮品卡**面值 50 元。

MCQ-ready definition:

gift card = 預先儲有一定金額、可在指定商店或平台消費的卡

3. **greeting card** — 賀卡 ; 心意卡

Practice 1

> She sent me a **greeting card**.

她寄給我一張**賀卡**。

Practice 2

> I bought a **greeting card** for my grandmother.

我買了一張**賀卡**給外婆。

MCQ-ready definition:

greeting card = 用來表達祝賀、慰問、感謝或心意的卡片

4. **birthday card** — 生日卡

Practice 1

> He wrote a message in the **birthday card**.

他在**生日卡**裏寫了一段留言。

Practice 2

> I received several **birthday cards**.

我收到幾張**生日卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

birthday card = 為祝賀某人生日而送出的卡片

5. **Christmas / wedding / thank-you card** — 聖誕卡 / 婚禮卡 / 感謝卡

Practice 1

> She sent us a **thank-you card** after the wedding.

婚禮後她寄了一張**感謝卡**給我們。

Practice 2

> We exchanged **Christmas cards**.

我們互送**聖誕卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

X card = 為某個特定節日、場合或用途而設的卡片

6. **bank card** — 銀行卡

A major modern sense.

Practice 1

> I paid with my **bank card**.

我用**銀行卡**付款。

Practice 2

> He lost his **bank card** yesterday.

他昨天不見了**銀行卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bank card = 由銀行發出、可用於付款、提款或其他銀行服務的卡

7. **credit card** — 信用卡

Practice 1

> She paid by **credit card**.

她用**信用卡**付款。

Practice 2

> The hotel requires a **credit card** for the booking.

酒店預訂需要提供**信用卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

credit card = 允許持卡人先使用信用額消費，再按帳單還款的支付卡

8. **debit card** — 扣帳卡；提款卡

Practice 1

> I normally use a **debit card** for groceries.

我通常用**扣帳卡**買日用品。

Practice 2

> The money is taken directly from your account when you use a **debit card**.

使用**扣帳卡**時，款項會直接從戶口扣除。

MCQ-ready definition:

debit card = 付款時通常直接從銀行戶口扣款的支付卡

9. **pay by card — 用卡付款**

Practice 1

> Can I **pay by card**?

我可以**用卡付款**嗎？

Practice 2

> The shop accepts cash and **card**.

這間店接受現金和**信用 / 扣帳卡付款**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pay by card = 使用信用卡、扣帳卡等支付卡付款

10. **card payment — 卡付款；信用 / 扣帳卡交易**

Practice 1

> The machine isn't accepting **card payments**.

這部機暫時不能接受**卡付款**。

Practice 2

> Most customers now use **card payments**.

現在大部分顧客都使用**卡付款**。

MCQ-ready definition:

card payment = 透過支付卡完成的交易

11. **ID card / identity card — 身份證；身份卡**

Practice 1

> Please show your **ID card**.

請出示你的**身份證**。

Practice 2

> Students must carry their **identity cards**.

學生必須攜帶**身份證明卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ID card = 用來證明持有人身份的官方或機構卡片

12. **membership card — 會員卡**

Practice 1

> Show your **membership card** at the entrance.

入場時請出示**會員卡**。

Practice 2

> I forgot to bring my **membership card**.

我忘了帶**會員卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

membership card = 證明某人是某組織、會所或服務會員的卡

13. **loyalty card — 積分卡；會員優惠卡**

Practice 1

> Do you have a **loyalty card**?

你有**會員積分卡**嗎？

Practice 2

> Customers collect points with the **loyalty card**.

顧客使用**積分卡**累積積分。

MCQ-ready definition:

****loyalty card = 商店或品牌用來記錄消費、積分或提供優惠的會員卡****

14. ****business card — 名片****

Practice 1

> He gave me his ****business card****.

他給了我一張****名片****。

Practice 2

> Her phone number is on the ****business card****.

她的電話號碼印在****名片****上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****business card = 印有姓名、職位、公司及聯絡資料的小卡片****

15. ****name card — 名片****

Common in some Asian varieties of English, but ****business card**** is more standard internationally.

Practice 1

> He handed me his ****business card****.

他遞給我他的****名片****。

****Usage note:****

For IELTS/international English, prefer ****business card**** over ****name card****.

16. ****playing card — 紙牌；啤牌****

A major distinct branch.

Practice 1

> She picked up a ****playing card****.

她拿起一張**啤牌**。

Practice 2

> One **card** was missing from the deck.

那副牌少了一張**牌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

playing card = 用於紙牌遊戲的一張牌

17. **a pack / deck of cards — 一副啤牌**

Practice 1

> We bought a **pack of cards**.

我們買了一副**啤牌**。

Practice 2

> Shuffle the **deck of cards**.

把那副**牌洗一洗**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a pack/deck of cards = 一整套用來玩紙牌遊戲的紙牌

18. **card suit — 花色**

Practice 1

> Hearts and clubs are two **card suits**.

紅心和梅花是兩種**紙牌花色**。

Practice 2

> Each **suit** contains several cards.

每個**花色**都有多張牌。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****card suit = 紙牌中按符號分類的一組牌，如 hearts、diamonds、clubs、spades****

19. ****face card — 人頭牌；花牌****

Practice 1

> A king is a ****face card****.

K 是一張****人頭牌****。

Practice 2

> She drew a ****face card****.

她抽到一張****花牌****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****face card = 紙牌中的 king、queen 或 jack****

20. ****report card — 成績單；學生成績報告****

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> He brought home his ****report card****.

他把****成績單****帶回家。

Practice 2

> Her ****report card**** showed strong improvement.

她的****成績報告****顯示有明顯進步。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****report card = 學校定期列出學生成績、表現或評語的文件****

21. ****scorecard — 計分卡；評分表****

Practice 1

> The golfer checked his **scorecard**.

高爾夫球手查看自己的**計分卡**。

Practice 2

> The organization publishes an annual performance **scorecard**.

該機構每年發布一份表現**評分表**。

MCQ-ready definition:

scorecard = 記錄分數、成績或多項表現指標的表格 / 卡

22. **red card** — 紅牌

A sports sense.

Practice 1

> The player was shown a **red card**.

那名球員被出示**紅牌**。

Practice 2

> A **red card** means the player must leave the field.

紅牌表示球員必須離場。

MCQ-ready definition:

red card = 某些運動中表示嚴重犯規並要求球員離場的卡

23. **yellow card** — 黃牌

Practice 1

> The referee gave him a **yellow card**.

球證向他出示**黃牌**。

Practice 2

> He received a **yellow card** for the foul.

他因犯規收到一張**黃牌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

yellow card = 某些運動中對犯規球員發出的正式警告

24. **card someone (sports) — 向球員出示黃 / 紅牌**

Practice 1

> The referee **carded the defender**.

球證向那名後衛**出示了牌**。

Practice 2

> He was **carded** for a late tackle.

他因一次遲來攔截而**被出示黃 / 紅牌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

card a player = 在運動比賽中向球員出示警告或罰離場用的牌

25. **card someone (查驗年齡證件) — 要求出示身份證明**

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> The cashier **carded him** before selling the product.

收銀員在出售產品前要求他**出示年齡證明**。

Practice 2

> You may be **carded** if you look young.

如果你看起來很年輕，可能會被要求**出示身份證明**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****card someone = 要求某人出示身份證件，以確認其年齡****

26. ****card (邀請卡 / 入場卡) — 邀請卡 ; 通行卡****

Practice 1

> You need an invitation ****card**** to enter.

你需要****邀請卡****才能入場。

Practice 2

> The hotel gave us a key ****card****.

酒店給了我們一張****房卡****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****card = 用作進入、身份識別或使用某項服務的卡片****

27. ****key card — 房卡 ; 門禁卡****

Practice 1

> Use the ****key card**** to open the door.

用****房卡 / 門卡****開門。

Practice 2

> I left my ****key card**** in the room.

我把****房卡****留在房間裏了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****key card = 用電子方式開門或進入受限制區域的卡****

28. ****SIM card — SIM 卡****

Practice 1

> Insert the **SIM card** into the phone.

把 **SIM 卡** 插進手機。

Practice 2

> I need a local **SIM card**.

我需要一張本地 **SIM 卡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

SIM card = 手機中用來識別流動網絡用戶並連接網絡的小型晶片卡

29. **memory card** — 記憶卡；儲存卡

Practice 1

> The camera uses a **memory card**.

這部相機使用**記憶卡**。

Practice 2

> The **memory card** is full.

記憶卡已滿。

MCQ-ready definition:

memory card = 用來儲存數碼資料的小型電子儲存裝置

30. **card** (資訊卡 / 索引卡) — 資料卡；索引卡

Practice 1

> Write one vocabulary word on each **card**.

每張**卡片**寫一個生字。

Practice 2

> She studied using flash **cards**.

她用**字卡**溫習。

MCQ-ready definition:

card = 用來記錄少量資料、學習內容或索引資料的小卡片

31. **flashcard** — 字卡；學習卡

Practice 1

> I use **flashcards** to learn vocabulary.

我用**字卡**學習生字。

Practice 2

> Each **flashcard** has a word on one side and a definition on the other.

每張**學習卡**一面有單字，另一面有解釋。

MCQ-ready definition:

flashcard = 用於記憶和學習的小卡片，通常兩面放不同資訊

32. **calling card** (名片) — 名片

An older/formal sense.

Practice 1

> He left his **calling card** at the house.

他在那裏留下了自己的**名片**。

Practice 2

> In earlier periods, visitors often left a **calling card**.

以前訪客常會留下**拜訪名片**。

MCQ-ready definition:

calling card = traditionally, a small card bearing someone's name, left when visiting

33. **calling card** (特徵 ; 標誌) — 標誌性特徵

A figurative extension.

Practice 1

> Bold colours became the designer's **calling card**.

鮮豔色彩成為那位設計師的**標誌性特色**。

Practice 2

> Fast service is the company's **calling card**.

快速服務是公司的**招牌特色**。

MCQ-ready definition:

calling card = a recognizable feature strongly associated with a person, brand, or organization

34. **wild card** — 外卡 ; 變數 ; 出乎意料的因素

A major polysemous expression.

Practice 1

> She entered the tournament as a **wild card**.

她以**外卡資格**參加比賽。

Practice 2

> Weather is the **wild card** in our plan.

天氣是我們計劃中最大的**不確定因素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wild card = either a special competition entry, or an unpredictable factor that can change the outcome

35. **trump card — 王牌；殺手鐮**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 1

> He still has one **trump card** to play.

他仍然有一張**王牌 / 殺手鐮**可以打出。

Practice 2

> Experience was her **trump card** in the interview.

經驗是她面試時的**王牌優勢**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trump card = a powerful advantage kept for use at the right moment****

36. **play your cards right — 處理得當；懂得把握機會**

Practice 1

> If you **play your cards right**, you might get promoted.

如果你**處理得當 / 懂得把握機會**，可能會升職。

Practice 2

> She **played her cards right** and got the deal she wanted.

她**策略運用得宜**，最後得到想要的條件。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****play your cards right = handle a situation cleverly so that you get a good result****

37. **show / reveal your cards — 亮出底牌；表明真正打算**

Practice 1

> Neither side wanted to **show its cards** too early.

雙方都不想太早**亮出底牌**。

Practice 2

> He finally **revealed his cards**.

他終於**表明了真正打算**。

MCQ-ready definition:

show/reveal your cards = reveal your plans, intentions, or strategy

38. **keep your cards close to your chest — 不透露計劃；把底牌收好**

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> She **keeps her cards close to her chest**.

她很少**透露自己的真正打算**。

Practice 2

> The company is **keeping its cards close to its chest**.

公司正在**對計劃守口如瓶**。

MCQ-ready definition:

keep your cards close to your chest = keep your intentions or plans secret

39. **put / lay your cards on the table — 攤牌；坦白說明立場**

Practice 1

> It's time to **put our cards on the table**.

是時候**把立場和打算坦白說清楚**了。

Practice 2

> She **laid her cards on the table** and explained what she wanted.

她**攤牌**，清楚說明自己想要甚麼。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****put/lay your cards on the table = openly reveal your intentions, position, or information****

40. ****on the cards — 很可能發生****

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> A promotion could be ****on the cards****.

升職可能****很有機會發生****。

Practice 2

> More changes are ****on the cards****.

很可能還會有更多****變化****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be on the cards = be likely or possible in the near future****

41. ****in the cards — 命中可能發生；有可能****

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> A move abroad may be ****in the cards****.

搬到外國生活可能****很有可能發生****。

Practice 2

> Success wasn't ****in the cards**** that year.

那一年成功似乎****並不在命運安排之中 / 沒有發生的可能****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be in the cards = be likely, possible, or seemingly destined to happen****

42. **house of cards — 紙牌屋；脆弱易倒的體系**

Practice 1

> The children built a **house of cards**.

孩子們用紙牌堆了一座**紙牌屋**。

Practice 2

> Without funding, the whole plan could collapse like a **house of cards**.

如果沒有資金，整個計劃可能像**紙牌屋般迅速倒塌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

house of cards = literally a structure made from cards; figuratively, a fragile system likely to collapse

43. **cardholder (持卡人) — 持卡人**

Practice 1

> Only the **cardholder** may use the account.

只有**持卡人**可以使用該帳戶。

Practice 2

> The bank contacted the **cardholder**.

銀行聯絡了**持卡人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cardholder = the person officially issued or entitled to use a particular card

44. **cardholder (卡套) — 卡套；卡片夾**

A separate noun sense.

Practice 1

> She keeps her bank cards in a leather **cardholder**.

她把銀行卡放在皮製**卡套**裏。

Practice 2

> This **cardholder** can hold six cards.

這個**卡片夾**可以放六張卡。

MCQ-ready definition:

cardholder = a small case designed to hold cards

45. **cardboard — 硬紙板；紙皮**

A lexicalized family extension.

Practice 1

> The box is made of **cardboard**.

這個盒是用**硬紙板 / 紙皮**製成的。

Practice 2

> Cut a piece of **cardboard** for the model.

剪一塊**硬紙板**來做模型。

MCQ-ready definition:

cardboard = thick, stiff paper material used especially for boxes and packaging

46. **cardboard (figurative : 不真實、單薄的) — 單薄不立體的；沒有真實感的**

Practice 1

> The film was criticized for its **cardboard characters**.

這部電影被批評人物**單薄、不立體**。

Practice 2

> The villain felt like a **cardboard stereotype**.

那個反派角色感覺只是個**扁平而公式化的刻板形象**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cardboard = figuratively, lacking depth, realism, or complexity

Important distinction 1: **card vs paper**

card

usually thicker/stiffer than ordinary paper, or a functional card.

paper

general paper material.

> a birthday card

生日卡

> a sheet of paper

一張紙

Important distinction 2: **card vs ticket**

card

broad object with many functions:

- * payment
- * identification
- * greeting
- * membership

ticket

usually specifically grants entry, travel, or participation.

A **gift card** is not normally an event ticket.

Important distinction 3: **gift card vs gift voucher**

gift card

usually card-shaped or digital and often stores monetary value.

gift voucher

coupon/document entitling someone to goods, services, or value.

They overlap, especially in modern retail.

Important distinction 4: **gift card vs credit card**

gift card

usually prepaid with a fixed stored value.

credit card

lets the holder borrow/use credit up to a limit and repay later.

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 5: **debit card vs credit card**

debit card

normally takes money directly from your bank account.

credit card

uses borrowed credit first, repaid later.

Important distinction 6: **card vs cash**

cash

physical notes and coins.

card

payment instrument.

> pay in cash

用現金付款

> pay by card

用卡付款

Important distinction 7: **business card vs ID card**

business card

gives contact/professional information.

ID card

proves identity.

A business card is not official proof of identity.

Important distinction 8: **playing card vs card**

Bare **card** can mean a playing card when context is a card game.

> Pick a card.

抽一張牌。

But outside that context, **card** is much broader.

Important distinction 9: **report card vs scorecard**

report card

student performance report.

scorecard

records scores or evaluates multiple criteria.

A business may have a performance scorecard, but not normally a report card unless metaphorical.

Important distinction 10: **red card vs yellow card**

yellow card

warning.

red card

dismissal/ejection in many sports.

They represent different disciplinary levels.

Important distinction 11: **card someone = ID check vs sports punishment**

Retail/age verification

> The cashier carded him.

收銀員要求他出示年齡證明。

Sport

> The referee carded him.

球證向他出示黃 / 紅牌。

Same verb, completely different domain.

Important distinction 12: **wild card literal/domain vs figurative**

Competition

> enter as a wild card

以外卡資格參賽

Figurative

> weather is the wild card

天氣是不確定因素

The second means something unpredictable that can alter the result.

Important distinction 13: **trump card vs wild card**

trump card

known powerful advantage.

wild card

unpredictable factor or special entry.

> experience was her trump card

經驗是她的王牌

> weather was the wild card

天氣是最大變數

Important distinction 14: **play your cards right vs show your cards**

play your cards right

use strategy well.

show your cards

reveal your strategy.

One is about **managing the situation**; the other is about **revealing information**.

Important distinction 15: **on the cards vs in the cards**

on the cards

especially BrE.

in the cards

especially AmE.

Both can mean:

很可能發生

Important distinction 16: **calling card literal vs figurative**

Literal

> a calling card

名片

Figurative

> creativity is her calling card

創意是她的標誌性特色

The figurative sense means a recognizable signature trait.

Important distinction 17: **cardholder = person vs object**

Person

> credit-card holder

信用卡持有人

Object

> leather cardholder

皮製卡套

Same spelling, completely different referent.

Important distinction 18: **cardboard** is lexicalized

Although historically connected to **card**, modern learners should treat **cardboard** as its own lexicalized word:

> cardboard box

紙皮箱 / 硬紙板箱

The figurative adjective **cardboard character** then develops separately.

Family-extension note

Card has several major modern branches:

1. **greeting / message card**

- * birthday card
- * greeting card
- * thank-you card

2. **money / payment card**

- * gift card
- * bank card
- * credit card
- * debit card

3. **identity / access card**

- * ID card
- * membership card
- * key card

4. **information card**

- * business card
- * flashcard
- * report card
- * scorecard

5. **playing card**

- * deck of cards
- * face card
- * suit

6. **sports disciplinary card**

- * red card
- * yellow card
- * card a player

7. **verb: check ID**

- * card someone

8. **figurative card-game expressions**

- * trump card
- * wild card
- * play your cards right
- * show your cards
- * on the cards
- * house of cards

9. **family extensions**

- * cardholder
- * cardboard

The core concept is extremely broad, so **card** is genuinely high-value polysemy vocabulary.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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card	卡；卡片	general card	
gift card	禮品卡	prepaid value	
greeting card	賀卡	message/occasion	
birthday card	生日卡	birthday greeting	
bank card	銀行卡	banking access	
credit card	信用卡	credit payment	
debit card	扣帳卡	direct bank payment	
pay by card	用卡付款	payment method	
ID card	身份證 / 身份卡	identity	
membership card	會員卡	membership proof	
loyalty card	積分卡	rewards	
business card	名片	professional contact	
playing card	啤牌	card game	
deck/pack of cards	一副牌	full set	
face card	人頭牌	king/queen/jack	
report card	成績單	school performance	
scorecard	計分卡 / 評分表	scores/metrics	
red card	紅牌	dismissal	
yellow card	黃牌	warning	
card a player	向球員出牌	sports discipline	
card someone	查驗年齡證件	ID check	
key card	房卡 / 門禁卡	electronic access	
SIM card	SIM 卡	mobile network	
memory card	記憶卡	digital storage	
flashcard	字卡	learning tool	
calling card	名片 / 標誌性特徵	identity/signature	
wild card	外卡 / 變數	special entry/unpredictability	
trump card	王牌；殺手鐮	powerful advantage	
play your cards right	策略運用得宜	handle situation well	
show your cards	亮出底牌	reveal plans	
keep cards close to chest	不透露打算	secrecy	
cards on the table	攤牌	openness	
on the cards	很可能發生	likely	
in the cards	很可能 / 命中注定	likely/destined	
house of cards	紙牌屋 / 脆弱體系	fragile structure	
cardholder	持卡人 / 卡套	person/object	
cardboard	硬紙板；紙皮	stiff paper	
cardboard character	扁平角色	lacking depth	

For your original sentence

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, chocolates, wallets, or gift
cards.

Here:

gift card = 預先儲有一定金額、讓收禮者自行選購商品或服務的禮品卡

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、朱古力、銀包，或者**禮品卡**。

The key learner point is that **card** is an exceptionally broad noun. In this passage it is not **賀卡、銀行卡、名片、啤牌** or **紅黃牌**; it is specifically the retail-value sense inside the fixed compound **gift card**.